This is a critical engagement. Since Ethio Telecom has already landed, you must shift from "Planning Mode" to "Negotiation & Interrogation Mode." You need to signal immediately that Hawassa City is an informed client, not a passive purchaser.

Based on the **Master Blueprint** we have developed, here is a structured, high-impact questioning framework designed for the Mayor and the Technical Steering Committee to use in this meeting.

MEETING STRATEGY & AGENDA

Opening Stance:
"We value Ethio Telecom as our strategic national partner. However, Hawassa's MESOB is a high-stakes governance project, not a standard enterprise connectivity install. We require a solution that fits our specific hybrid needs, not a generic package off the shelf. We need clarity on the following 8 strategic dimensions before we sign."

CATEGORY 1: ARCHITECTURE & CLOUD STRATEGY (The "Hybrid" Demand)

Context: They will likely push a "Full Cloud" model because it is easier for them. You must defend the "Hybrid Edge" model to ensure the center works even if the fiber cuts.

1. **The Connectivity Reliance Risk:** "We know fiber cuts happen. If we go with your Full Cloud solution, what happens to the Hawassa MESOB Center when the link to Addis Ababa goes down? Do you offer a **Local Edge Server** solution that allows us to continue queuing and processing citizens offline, or does the center shut down?"
2. **Data Sovereignty & Residency:** "Where exactly will our data reside? Is it in the new Modular Data Center, the Addis cloud, or a regional node? If we choose to migrate to our own infrastructure in 3 years, what is the technical process to extract our SQL data from your cloud? Is there an exit penalty?"
3. **Why Cloud vs. On-Premise?** "Convince us. Why should Hawassa City pay monthly rent for Cloud Hosting versus buying our own servers once (CAPEX)? Show us the 5-year Total Cost of Ownership (TCO) comparison between the two models specifically for high-volume government transaction processing."

CATEGORY 2: PACKAGE CLARITY & FLEXIBILITY (Platinum vs. Standard)

Context: They will offer tiered packages. You need to know what is hidden in the fine print.

1. **Line-Item Transparency:** "We cannot accept a 'Black Box' package. Please break down the Platinum, Standard, and Basic packages line-by-line. Which specific hardware,

software licenses, and bandwidth speeds are included in each? What is the exact redundancy difference between Platinum and Standard?"

2. **Dynamic Flexibility:** "If we sign for the Standard Package today, but six months later we need the security features of Platinum, can we upgrade *only* the security module without paying for the full Platinum price? Can we scale up bandwidth during tax season and scale down afterwards?"
3. **The "Hidden" Costs:** "Are there any licensing fees, installation fees, or accessory costs (cables, patches, racks) that are excluded from these package prices? We need a 'Landed Cost' estimate."

CATEGORY 3: SECURITY & CREDENTIAL GOVERNANCE

Context: This was a major failure point in the Regional Benchmarking. You must assert control.

1. **Firewall & Credential Ownership:** "In other implementations, we've seen Ethio Telecom retain the root passwords for firewalls, leaving the client unable to make quick security changes. **Will you agree contractually to hand over full Admin/Root credentials to the Hawassa City IT Security Team upon commissioning?**"
2. **Cybersecurity Responsibility:** "If the MESOB Center is hacked or hit by ransomware while hosted on your infrastructure, where does the liability sit? Do your packages include active threat monitoring (SOC) and DDOS protection, or is that an extra cost?"
3. **Physical Access:** "For equipment installed in our building, do our staff have keys to the racks, or do we have to wait for your technicians to unlock them?"

CATEGORY 4: TECHNICAL DEPTH & HUMAN CAPITAL

Context: You are worried about the shortage of senior technicians in the region.

1. **The "Junior Tech" Risk:** "We are aware that your senior engineers are concentrated in Addis. Who exactly will be the **Project Manager** for Hawassa? We request to see the CVs of the specific technical team assigned to this project. Will they be physically present in Hawassa during the setup, or managing it remotely?"
2. **Installation Manpower:** "This project has a tight timeline. How many technicians will you deploy simultaneously for the cabling and installation? Can you guarantee a dedicated squad that works *only* on MESOB until completion, rather than rotating between projects?"

CATEGORY 5: TIMELINE, EXECUTION & GUARANTEES

Context: Time is sensitive.

1. **The Gantt Chart:** "Can you provide a detailed day-by-day breakdown of the implementation schedule? We need to see the dependencies—what civil works must be ready before you lay the fiber?"
2. **Performance Guarantees:** "What is your guarantee that you will deliver on schedule? If the project is delayed due to your lack of stock or manpower, are you willing to sign a

Penalty Clause or offer **Service Credits** (free months of service) for every week of delay?"
3. **Civil Works alignment:** "Our renovation is ongoing. How flexible is your team to work alongside our civil contractors? Will you provide the cabling trunking specifications *today* so we don't have to break walls later?"

CATEGORY 6: SUPPORT, MAINTENANCE & ESCALATION

Context: When things break, you need immediate fixes, not a call center.

1. **Response Time (SLA):** "Standard corporate SLAs (e.g., 4-hour response) do not work for a MESOB Center serving thousands of angry citizens. Will you commit to a **30-minute onsite response time** for critical (P1) outages? What is the escalation ladder if the local technician doesn't pick up the phone?"
2. **Spare Parts Inventory:** "Do you hold spare routers, switches, and fiber patches *in Hawassa stock*, or do we have to wait for them to be shipped from Addis when something breaks?"

CATEGORY 7: FINANCIAL MODEL (Payment Modality)

Context: You need to align this with your "Tech Fee" revenue model.

1. **CAPEX vs. OPEX:** "We prefer to minimize upfront cash outflow. Are you willing to amortize the cost of the hardware (Servers, Switches, Cabling) over a 3-5 year monthly contract (OPEX model), or do you demand 100% upfront payment?"
2. **Revenue Sharing Potential:** "Since we are driving thousands of digital payments through Telebirr via this center, do we get a preferential transaction rate? Can we discuss a revenue-share model where your infrastructure costs are offset by the Telebirr transaction volume we generate?"

CATEGORY 8: THE "HAWASSA ADVANTAGE" (The Deal Sweetener)

Context: Why should you choose them? What is special for Hawassa?

1. **The Unique Offer:** "Hawassa is a Regional Capital and an Industrial Hub. Other than the standard price list, what is the **peculiar offer** or strategic incentive you are giving specifically to Hawassa City? Are you willing to sponsor the 'Mayoral Court' teleconferencing setup or the Public Wi-Fi zone as a CSR (Corporate Social Responsibility) initiative?"
2. **Why You?** "We have options to build our own local data center and just buy raw fiber from you. Why should we choose your Managed Services (Cloud) over building it ourselves? Convince us on the security and reliability front, not just price."

RECOMMENDED CLOSING STATEMENT FOR THE MAYOR

"Gentlemen, we want to sign with you. But we are building a governance institution, not an internet cafe. If you can answer these questions satisfactorily and put them in writing in the contract, we are ready to move. If not, we will be forced to look at alternative architectural models."

This is an excellent strategic pivot. By asking about their **past failures and specific technical hurdles**, you shift the dynamic from a "Sales Pitch" to a "Technical Audit." You force them to be honest about the messy reality of implementation.

Here are the **Additional High-Impact Categories** to add to your interrogation agenda.

CATEGORY 9: EXPERIENCE SHARING & REALITY CHECK (The "Truth Serum")

Context: They have deployed in Addis, Adama, and Dessie. You need to know what went wrong there so you don't repeat it.

1. **The "Dessie & Adama" Precedent:** "You have rolled out similar infrastructure in other regional cities. Be honest with us: **What was the single biggest cause of delay in those projects?** Was it the city not being ready, or your supply chain? How have you adjusted your plan for Hawassa based on those mistakes?"
2. **The Blame Game:** "In other cities, we hear complaints that when the system is slow, Ethio Telecom blames the software (EAII), and the software team blames the network. **How do we prevent this finger-pointing in Hawassa?** Can we have a unified dashboard where we can *see* exactly where the latency is?"
3. **User Complaints:** "What is the most frequent technical complaint you receive from the *bureau clerks* in other centers? Is it login timeouts? Printer connectivity? fluctuating speeds? We want to solve these before our staff sits down."

CATEGORY 10: "HIDDEN" TECHNICAL DETAILS (The Things They Usually Don't Mention)

Context: Sales teams talk about 'Cloud'; engineers talk about 'Voltage'. You need to ask about the unsexy details that cause outages.

1. **Power Conditioning (Not just Backup):** "We know Hawassa has power fluctuations. A UPS provides backup, but does your equipment include **Industrial Voltage Stabilizers**? If a power surge burns the router, is that our cost or yours?"
2. **The "Last Meter" Cabling:** "In your previous projects, did you use CAT6 or CAT6A cabling? Who is responsible for the structured cabling inside the walls? If a rat chews a cable in the ceiling 6 months from now, is fixing that part of your SLA, or do we need a separate maintenance contract?"
3. **Integration with EAII (The Handshake):** "Have your technical teams actually tested the connection between your proposed Hosting Environment and the specific 'Nine Systems' provided by the AI Institute? Do we need to open specific **Firewall Ports** or VPN tunnels for them? We don't want to discover compatibility issues on launch day."
4. **Static IPs & Public Access:** "Will you provide static Public IPs for our API Gateway so we can integrate with banks? Is this included in the package cost, or is it a recurring extra charge?"

CATEGORY 11: PRE-REQUISITES (What They Need From You)

Context: Flip the script. Ask them to define exactly what Hawassa must do to avoid being the bottleneck.

1. **The "Civil Works" Stop-Gate:** "You are here to deploy. Look at our building. **What specific civil work is missing right now that would stop you from installing tomorrow?** Do we need specific cooling units (BTUs) in the server room? Do we need specific grounding/earthing standards? Tell us now, in writing."
2. **Room Readiness:** "Do you require a raised floor for the server room, or is overhead cabling acceptable? What is the exact physical dimension of the racks you are bringing so we can mark the floor plan?"

CATEGORY 12: STRATEGIC INSIGHT (Their Professional Recommendation)

Context: Use their expertise, but verify it.

1. **The "Hybrid" Validation:** "You are the experts. Given Hawassa's distance from the central cloud in Addis, and the history of fiber cuts along the route, **would you honestly recommend we run *without* a local edge server?** If you were in our shoes, wouldn't you insist on local redundancy?"
2. **Telebirr Integration:** "We want to make this center cashless. What is the fastest way to integrate Telebirr into our workflow? Do you have ready-made APIs for government fee collection, or do we have to build that from scratch? Can you show us a city where this is working perfectly right now?"

STRATEGIC TIP FOR THE MEETING

The "Walk-Through" Tactic:
Don't just sit in the boardroom. After the initial Q&A, take the Ethio Telecom team to the physical building site immediately.

- Ask them to point at the wall and say: *"Where does the fiber enter?"*
- Ask them to look at the power outlet and say: *"Is this grounded enough for your rack?"*

This forces them to stop selling "concepts" and start solving "physical reality."